

Booking & Payments Guide

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Getting paid should be frictionless for clients and predictable for you. This guide covers booking systems, payment processors, deposits, recurring billing, and the policies that protect your revenue.

Booking System Overview

What You Need

Function	Why It Matters
Online booking	Clients book 24/7 without phone tag
Calendar sync	No double-bookings
Automated reminders	Reduces no-shows 30–50%
Payment collection	Card on file before or after service
Client CRM	History, notes, recurring schedules

Recommended Platforms

Platform	Strengths	Best For
Stripe + booking add-on	Best payment infrastructure, subscriptions	Scaling companies
Square Appointments	Simple, in-person + online, free tier	Starting out
Jobber	Field service + payments	Teams with cleaners
Housecall Pro	Scheduling, dispatch, payments	Growing teams
ZenMaid	Cleaning-specific	Residential focus
Calendly + Stripe	Lightweight	Solo operators

100% Cleaner recommendation: Start with **Square** or **Jobber** for simplicity. Move to **Stripe** when you need subscriptions, complex pricing, or API integrations.

Stripe Setup

Why Stripe

- Industry-standard payment processing
- Recurring billing and subscriptions built-in
- Customer portal for card updates
- Works with most booking software
- 2.9% + \$0.30 per transaction (US, card-not-present)

Setup Checklist

- ☐ Create account at stripe.com (business type: cleaning services)
- ☐ Connect business bank account
- ☐ Enable payment links for one-off invoices
- ☐ Set up Stripe Checkout for website bookings
- ☐ Configure email receipts with your logo
- ☐ Enable Stripe Billing for recurring clients
- ☐ Test mode → live mode when ready

Stripe Products You'll Use

Product	Use Case
Payment Links	Send quote → client pays → confirmed
Checkout	Website booking with upfront payment
Invoicing	Net-15 commercial clients
Billing / Subscriptions	Weekly/bi-weekly recurring cleans
Customer Portal	Client updates card, views invoices

Stripe + Website Integration

If using Next.js or similar:

- Stripe Checkout for one-time bookings
- Stripe Customer + Subscription for recurring
- Webhook to confirm booking in your database after `checkout.session.completed`

Never store raw card numbers yourself. Let Stripe handle PCI compliance.

Square Setup

Why Square

- Free appointment scheduling
- POS for in-person card tap
- No monthly fee (pay per transaction)
- Client directory built-in

Setup Checklist

- ☐ Square account + Square Appointments
- ☐ Service menu (Regular, Deep, Move-Out, add-ons)
- ☐ Booking widget on website / Google Business Profile
- ☐ Card on file at booking (optional but recommended)
- ☐ Automatic reminder texts (24 hr + 1 hr)
- ☐ Tip option (optional — more common for solo)

Square Fees

- 2.6% + \$0.10 (in-person)
- 3.3% + \$0.30 (online invoiced)
- No monthly software fee for basic appointments

Deposits — When & How Much

Why Require Deposits

- Reduces no-shows and last-minute cancellations
- Filters non-serious inquiries
- Covers scheduling cost if client cancels inside window

Recommended Deposit Structure

Service	Deposit	When to Collect
Regular recurring	None (card on file instead)	First booking
First-time deep clean	25–50%	At booking

Move-out	50%	At booking
Large custom quote (\$500+)	50%	At booking
Holiday / peak dates	50%	At booking

Deposit Policy Language

"A 50% deposit is required to reserve your appointment. Deposits are applied to your final invoice. Deposits are non-refundable within 48 hours of your scheduled service. See our [Cancellation Policy](#)."

How to Collect

1. **At online booking** — Stripe/Square charges deposit automatically
2. **After phone quote** — send payment link via text/email
3. **Card on file** — authorize \$1, charge deposit or full amount later

Never start a move-out or deep clean without deposit or card on file.

Cancellation Fees

See full template: [Cancellation Policy](#)

Quick Reference

Notice	Fee
48+ hours	No fee, full refund of deposit
24–48 hours	50% of quoted price
Less than 24 hours	100% of quoted price
No-show	100% + may require prepay for rebooking

Enforcement: Charge the card on file. Document cancellation time in CRM.

Recurring Bookings

Recurring Schedule Types

Frequency	Typical Client	Pricing
Weekly	Large families, high-traffic homes	Standard rate
Bi-weekly	Most common recurring	Standard rate
Monthly	Light maintenance	+10–15% per visit (less frequent)

Setting Up Recurring in Stripe

1. Create Product: "Bi-Weekly Regular Clean — \$150"
2. Create Price: recurring, every 2 weeks
3. Client subscribes at booking or after first visit
4. Charge triggers automatically; you schedule manually or via integration

Setting Up Recurring in Square

1. Create recurring appointment series in Square Appointments
2. Enable automatic payments for each occurrence
3. Client receives reminder before each charge

Recurring Client Rules

- Same cleaner when possible (consistency = retention)
- Lock pricing for 6–12 months, then annual review
- 30-day notice for client cancellation of recurring service
- Card must stay current — pause service if payment fails twice

Subscriptions vs. Per-Visit Billing

Model	Pros	Cons
Per-visit charge	Pay only when serviced; easy skips	More transaction fees
Monthly subscription	Predictable revenue; one charge	Complex when client skips
Package (e.g., 4 cleans/month)	Upsell commitment	Refund complexity

100% Cleaner recommendation: Per-visit auto-charge for residential. Monthly subscription for commercial contracts with fixed scope.

Payment Timing Options

Model	When Charged	Best For
Pay at booking	Upfront	Deep cleans, new clients
Pay after service	Within 24 hours	Established recurring
Card on file	Auto-charge after completion	Recurring residential
Invoice (Net 15)	Commercial only	Offices, property managers

Failed Payment Protocol

1. Automatic retry (Stripe: 3 attempts over 2 weeks)
2. Text client day 1: "Payment failed — update card here [link]"
3. Pause scheduling until resolved
4. Never send cleaner to new job if previous invoice unpaid

Tipping

Approach	Notes
Enable in app	10–20% option after service
Cash preferred by some cleaners	Don't require
Company policy	Tips go 100% to cleaner (builds retention)

Tax & Invoicing

- Collect sales tax only if required in your state (many states exempt residential cleaning; verify locally)
- Issue receipt for every transaction
- Use [Invoice Template](#) for commercial clients
- 1099-K threshold — processors report to IRS; keep books clean

Pricing Display on Booking Page

Show **starting at** prices to filter tire-kickers:

Regular Clean (up to 3 bed / 2 bath) – from \$150

Deep Clean – from \$300

Move-Out – custom quote

Final price confirmed after intake form or phone consult.

Add-ons as checkboxes with prices (+\$50 laundry, +\$40 oven, etc.)

Security Best Practices

- ☐ HTTPS on booking page
 - ☐ PCI compliance via Stripe/Square (never handle raw cards)
 - ☐ Two-factor auth on payment dashboard
 - ☐ Separate login for bookkeeper vs. owner
 - ☐ Reconcile payouts weekly against job log
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Implementation Timeline

Week	Action
1	Choose platform, create account, add services
2	Embed booking widget on website, test booking
3	Connect payments, test deposit flow
4	Migrate recurring clients, send new payment links
5	Train team on "card on file" policy

Payments are not optional infrastructure — they are part of your product. 100% Cleaner / The Cleaning CEO Blueprint.